Recall Coding

Step 1: Parse and Match to Story Units

Resources needed: causal connection story unit guide, glossary for the story, subject's recall protocol.

1. Parse the recall protocol into thought units that match (as possible) story units
2. Write the story unit # above the parsed thought unit
3. If a thought unit cannot be matched to a single (or two adjacent) story unit, write the no match code above the thought unit (NMC, NMI). Also use NMC or NMI if the thought unit matches several story units.

Guidelines:

a. Use the parsed story units (causal connections for the story) to guide parsing of the recall.
b. Parse the thought unit to match one story unit whenever possible
c. If two adjacent (or, in rare instances, *almost* adjacent) story units are combined, both story unit #s may be used (e.g., 1,2 or 2,3)
d. Each story unit # may only be used one time. If the subject repeats the story unit, the earlier ones are considered repeats. Write (R) next to the story unit #. The final instance of the story unit # is coded.
e. If words inside a longer thought unit match a separate story unit, draw an arc under the inside words. The arc (scoop) should connect the two parts of the longer thought unit.
f. When using an arc (scoop), write the story unit # above the earlier part of the thought unit (e.g., 12 goes above "and then um he met" and the space above "named Ben" is left blank even though it is part of the #12 thought unit)

   i. Example: 12 NMC /And then um he met a new friend named Ben/



g. If "[inaudible]" makes it impossible to parse or code, mark [T] in the left margin (right margin is kept clear for scoring). Listen to the original recording and insert correct word(s), if audible. Correct the electronic transcript of the recall. Cross out [T] after listening. Code accordingly.

Step 2: Code Parsed Thought Units

1. Go through the entire protocol and attach codes to each story unit # or NM thought unit. Adjust parsing and matching as needed.
2. The codes that may apply to the **matched** thought units are defined below:
    a. **C (conservative match)**: The subject's thought unit **directly matches** a story unit and is a literal or nearly literal rendering of the original story unit. Note that a high proportion of conservative clauses reflects (near-) verbatim memory of the text, but few inferences or elaborations. Glossary examples may show words that must be included in bold, and acceptable synonyms for bolded words. Guidelines:
    b. **L (liberal match)**: The subject's thought unit **directly matches** a story unit and captures the gist of the story unit (the essence of its meaning). Paraphrasing may be present. Note that a high proportion of liberal clauses reflects the extent to which the reader has established a coherent representation of the text. Note common synonyms that constitute an L. Guidelines for coding L:
        i. Seeing it happen vs. it happening (story unit says it one way, thought unit says it the other)
        ii. Thinking vs. doing (story unit says it one way, thought unit says it the other)
        iii. Able to do something vs. doing something (story unit says it one way, thought unit says it the other)
        iv. Deciding to do something vs. doing something(story unit says it one way, thought unit says it the other)
        v. If there is an inference from the story unit to the thought unit
        vi. Additional information is inserted into the thought unit (extension or elaboration from story unit).
    c. **MI (matched but incorrect):** The subject's thought unit directly matches a story unit, but is significantly incorrect. MI is reserved for absolutely and importantly contradictory interpretations, not just an erroneous detail of the story. (Note: All MIs will be reviewed. Attach a sticky note alerting that an MI was coded to flag the protocol for review.)

3. The codes that may apply to **unmatched** thought units are defined below:
    a. **NMC (no match consistent)**: The subject's thought unit **cannot be matched directly** to the gist meaning of any one (or two adjacent) story unit, but it is **valid, consistent with (constrained by) the information in the text**, or plausible. Note that no match consistent clauses reflect the extent to which the reader has elaborated his/her mental representation of the text through inferences.
    b. **NMI** (no match inconsistent): The subject's thought unit is **invalid, inconsistent (unconstrained by) the information in the text**. The thought unit should be flat-out incorrect to be NMI. Note that no match inconsistent clauses suggest that the reader has constructed an erroneous, or partly erroneous, representation of the text.

FAQs (and OAQs) for recall coding

- Q **How literal must a C be?** If the subject's thought unit words literally match words/ideas in a story unit, it is a C. The fact that the original story unit has *additional words/ideas* does not negate the Conservative (C) match.

- **But when some words or ideas are missing, how do I decide that the missing words or incomplete idea changes the code from C to L?** If the information that was left out is important to the function or meaning of the current story sentence, then the thought unit is coded L. Importance is evaluated in light of preceding story context. If the missing information is unimportant details, code C. See examples below.

  1101 Sam: build nests (should be C-9. The important information in "and build nests in the trees in the local park" is building nests; the other phrases are details that are not important.)

  1051 Sam: Sam was new (should be L-3. Important information is missing from "He was new to the city")

- **How closely verbatim should a C be? Should context drive the decision between C and L?** Generally use the literal or nearly literal rule. A deviation from the original story unit is on a continuum from C to L, that is, in some cases it's hard to decide (it just is!). Ask two or three coders for their *first impressions* (no fair arguing your point of view) and use the majority to decide.

  1096 Annie: She saw the dolphins (should be L-7. In "Annie watched wild dolphins," "watched" is intentional, while "saw" is casual or could even be accidental. It's important that Annie was intentionally watching.)

- **How to code if pronouns are ambiguous or erroneous?** If the antecedent of the pronoun *could* include the actual antecedent, code C (assuming the rest of the thought unit is C). If the antecedent of the thought unit pronoun is *not* the actual antecedent, but it does not violate the story line, code L (assuming the thought unit matches a story unit and matches the gist, etc.).

  He said (it was odd) is coded C-23, because "he" could be Sam and SU 23 is "Sam said."
  1495 Annie: They said (should be L-47. "They" could include Annie, who actually said something in SU 47.)

- **What if the subject uses a wrong word?** Apply the C and L standards. If the student misunderstood a detail of the story text, it is unlikely that the retell will be a conservative match. Whether it is an L or an MI depends on how important the error is. Save MI-# for significant errors and misinterpretations that match a single story unit.

  For example, if a Ben quote or action is attributed to Sam, it's coded L.

  If the subject gives an incorrect *reason* that the characters did something (but they did do it), it's an L.

  1096 Dragon: And then the king was revealed (should be L-48. "The king was relieved") Not an important enough misunderstanding to qualify as MI.

- **Where to parse when the subject hems, haws and repeats?** When subject makes a false start, repeats words or phrases or self-corrects, include them all into the same parsed thought unit (as matched to the story unit). If there is more than one complete thought unit and each would be coded differently, code only the final statement, and code the earlier thought unit as (R).

- **How do I differentiate between L and MI?** MI must directly and importantly contradict story information. See examples below:

  1101 Spider: they wanted to go exploring without permission again (should be MI-49, because "they would never go exploring without permission again" relates to the moral of the story. Incorrectly retold.)

  1057 Spider: And so while they were taking a nap (should be MI-14, because the children made their escape "when their mother was napping"—it would never have happened if they were taking a nap.)

  1416 Sam: because he wanted new friends (in relation to going to his mom's work. (should be L-5 "he wanted to make new friends soon" although Sam didn't go to work *because* he wanted to make new friends, it's close enough. Not a significant enough deviation to use this special case code.)

- **How do I differentiate NMI from NMC?** Only code as inconsistent (NMI or MI) if a thought unit ***flat out contradicts the story***. If the *function* of the information is consistent with or *plausibly consistent* with the story, it should be coded NMC or L.

- **What's the best criterion for choosing the matched story unit?** When choosing which story unit matches a thought unit, think about the function of the content of each. See Glossary for Sam, Liberal story unit #47.

- **What if an SU is retold multiple times?** Each story unit can only be represented in the recall one time. If a story unit is repeated, only code the final instance of that story unit. Write (R) next to the SU # on the earlier instances.

Step 3: Score Coded Protocols

Before scoring, check for MI codes. If there are any MI codes, they must be reviewed by KM before the protocol is scored.

1. Count the recall codes
    a. Count and record the number of each code in the scoring boxes at the top of the page: Cs, Ls, NMCs, NMIs, MIs.
    b. If a code corresponds to more than one story unit #, count the number of story units matched to that code (e.g., L-1,3 counts as two Ls)

Scoring Box

Counter 1:_____ Counter 2:_____

C	L	NMC	NMI	MI

Total HC:_____

2. Order of recall
    a. In the right margin of the recall protocol, write in a vertical list from first to last, the story unit numbers that correspond to the C and L thought units. Do not list the MI story unit numbers.
    b. The list will likely **not** be in order or include all story unit #s.
    c. If the MI box at the top of the page is greater than 0, double check the MIs in the protocol. Make sure their story unit numbers are not included in the order of recall list.

3. Code highly connected (HC) thought units
    a. Highly connected story units are in bold type and highlighted on the causal connection story unit guide.
    b. Using the list of recalled story unit numbers in the right margin, draw a box around the highly connected story unit numbers: e.g., 26

4. Count highly connected thought units
    a. Count the number of boxed (highly connected) recalled story units
    b. Write the number on the "Total HC:__" line on the scoring label at the top of the page.

5. Double counting
    a. One person counts codes, writes the order of recall, and counts highly connected codes, and records in the scoring box. Initials "Counter 1:___"
    b. A second person counts codes, writes the order of recall, and counts highly connected codes, and makes corrections in the scoring box as needed. Initials "Counter 2:___"